

RELOCATION · HOUSTON

The Ultimate Houston Medical Relocation Guide

*Everything a physician, resident, fellow, or nurse
needs to know before the move — from a Realtor who
was an RN first.*



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GUIDING YOU HOME.
WHEREVER LIFE TAKES YOU.

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SEAMLESS RELOCATION

PERSONALIZED SERVICE

TRUSTED LOCAL NETWORK

YOUR GUIDE TO THE MOVE

Relocating for a role in medicine is not an ordinary move. You're starting a residency, a fellowship, an attending position, or a new chapter for your whole household — often on a hospital's timeline, not your own.

Between matching, credentialing, and the first day of orientation, housing is the one decision that has to happen fast and can't be undone cheaply. Most guides skip the specifics that matter to medical families: the *real* commute to the Texas Medical Center, which systems actually help with the move, how licensure timelines work, and where physician lending changes the math.

This guide is written by a licensed Texas REALTOR® who was a registered nurse first. Take it one section at a time — and when you're ready to talk specifics, reach out directly.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 1 How medical families choose where to live
- 2 TMC apartments & neighborhoods
- 3 Hospital-system relocation assistance
- 4 Visa, licensure & board exams
- 5 Private tutoring for a mid-year transition
- 6 Resources for medical families
- 7 The rent vs. buy framework
- 8 Physician mortgage lenders

HOW MEDICAL FAMILIES CHOOSE WHERE TO LIVE

Picture the week after Match Day. The offer is signed, orientation has a date, and a city you may have visited once now has to become home — for you, and usually for a partner and kids rearranging their whole lives around your schedule. Where you land quietly shapes every ordinary day that follows: the drive you make half-asleep post-call, whether your spouse keeps their career, how fast the kids settle in. Before we ever open a listing, we get honest about what your family is really solving for.

> **Commute to the Texas Medical Center**

On a map, one mile looks like the obvious win. But at 6 a.m. shift change, a building three miles out on the METRORail can land you on your floor faster — and far calmer — than the one you can see from the parking garage. Drive your real route at your real hours before you fall for a floor plan.

> **Career Stage**

A first-year resident and a newly minted attending are shopping for two different lives. Early on, a short commute and a lease you can walk away from matter most; a few years later it's school zoning, a yard, and room to actually stay a while. Naming where you sit on that arc keeps the search honest.

> **Rent vs. Buy Timeline**

How long you expect to be in Houston is the quiet decision sitting behind every other one. A three-year training stop and a put-down-roots move point in opposite directions — and guessing wrong here is the expensive mistake. We start with your timeline so the rest of the plan holds together.

> **Lifestyle Fit**

Days off are rare and precious — the neighborhood should hand them back to you. Some people recharge on a walkable street full of coffee shops and noise; others need a quiet block and a little space to breathe. There's no right answer, only the one that matches how you actually rest.

> **Daily Logistics**

A home works — or quietly falls apart — in the details: daycare that opens before rounds, parking you're not circling for, a partner's own commute, and a real plan for the overnight and weekend calls. We map the ordinary Tuesday, not just the day of the tour.

> **Buying vs. Selling Goals**

If you already own here and you're moving across town or up in size, you're playing both sides of the board at once. Timing the sale against the purchase — and positioning your current home to show beautifully — matters every bit as much as the next address. We plan the two moves as one.

SECTION TWO

TMC APARTMENTS & NEIGHBORHOODS

These are the apartment communities closest to the Texas Medical Center, sorted by distance. Drive times are typical off-peak estimates — always test your route at shift change. Nothing here is gated; it's the same list I'd walk a client through on day one.

COMMUNITY	DISTANCE	DRIVE	NOTE
Elan Medical Center	0.4 mi	2 min	Closest to campus
Life Tower	0.7 mi	5 min	High-rise, walkable
The Latitude Med Center	0.8 mi	5 min	
Allure Hermann Park	1.1 mi	7 min	Park-adjacent
Sync Med Center	1.3 mi	7 min	
Plaza Museum District	1.7 mi	9 min	
5755 Hermann Park	1.7 mi	9 min	
Hanover Rice Village	2.1 mi	11 min	Shops & dining
The Muse at Museum District	2.8 mi	13 min	
Hanover Montrose	2.9 mi	13 min	
The Sinclair	3.1 mi	14 min	
The Halstead	4.6 mi	15 min	
Verdir Hermann Park	5.0 mi	15 min	
Inverness Apartments	6.3 mi	17 min	
The Weston NEW	Rice Village	—	Educator discount
Regard at Med Center NEW	Med Center	—	
The Lanesborough NEW	METRORail	—	Smithlands stop — car-free

Pricing and availability move quickly in this market — re-verify current rates directly with each community before you tour.

NEIGHBORHOODS BY COMMUTE

Once you know your commute tolerance, whole neighborhoods open up. Here's how the areas around TMC group by drive profile — from car-free rail options to family suburbs.

10–15 MIN DRIVE

Braes Heights · Rice Village · Montrose · Southgate · Museum District · Bellaire · West University

SUBURBAN

Willow Meadows / Willowbend (10–15 min) · Pearland (20–30 min) — more space for growing families.

MONTROSE — ARTSY & WALKABLE NEW

2–4 mi out. The Susanne · 299 West Gray · Encore Montrose.

GALLERIA / UPTOWN

~9 min off-peak, corporate & upscale. Camden Post Oak · Ivy at The Galleria — ideal when one spouse works outside TMC.

MIDTOWN — ON THE RED LINE (genuinely car-free TMC commute)

Ride the Red Line straight into the Medical Center — no parking, no shift-change traffic. Drewery Place · Mid Main Lofts · Hadley Midtown.

★ INSIDER TIP — SHARED UNIVERSITY HOUSING

UTHealth, Baylor College of Medicine, and MD Anderson jointly operate below-market **University Housing** open to affiliates of all three institutions — Phase One at 7900 Cambridge, with Phases Two and Three added since. Most incoming physicians never hear it exists. Ask your GME office early; availability is limited.

FURNISHED & SHORT-TERM

For fellows on rotation, or families staying near TMC during a course of treatment, furnished corporate housing is a genuinely different use case than a standard lease. **Luxurway** and **JUVITAE** both specialize in it.

RELOCATING FOR NURSING SCHOOL?

Out-of-area students at Prairie View A&M's College of Nursing and Texas Woman's University's Houston campus — both inside the Medical Center — need TMC housing too. The rail lines and neighborhoods above apply just the same.

SECTION THREE

HOSPITAL-SYSTEM RELOCATION ASSISTANCE

Relocation benefits vary widely and are often negotiated per offer. Here's what's publicly documented, system by system — presented honestly, so you know where to ask rather than assume.

MD Anderson

MOST DOCUMENTED

The clearest published program: stated relocation assistance, the Woodlands Express commuter bus, a transit FSA, Bright Horizons back-up childcare, and 120 hours of vacation at the start of PRS trainee appointments.

Houston Methodist

NEGOTIATED PER ROLE

No single published policy. Benefits are negotiated per role — one posting, for example, listed a \$10K relocation bonus. Treat it as a starting point for your own conversation.

Memorial Hermann & Texas Children's

ASK YOUR RECRUITER

No public policy found — standard for large systems. Terms are set per offer, so this is a “confirm with your recruiter” item. Ask directly and get it in writing.

Baylor College of Medicine

DIY LISTINGS

Maintains its own “Housing in Houston” page but explicitly does not vouch for the listings on it. That gap — between a list of links and real local guidance — is exactly where I come in.

LOOKING AHEAD — BEYOND TMC

TMC isn't the only game in town. Houston Methodist runs 8+ community hospitals and Memorial Hermann 17 across Katy, Sugar Land, The Woodlands, Cypress and more. [Baylor St. Luke's](#) is a major teaching hospital right in the TMC, while [HCA Houston Healthcare](#), [CHRISTUS Health](#), St. Joseph Medical Center, and Kindred's long-term acute-care hospitals (some in the TMC, some around town) add large employers too — though not every one runs residencies or fellowships. Ask which campus, and which kind of role, fits you.

VISA, LICENSURE & BOARD EXAMS

A note on scope: This is orientation, not legal advice. Immigration pathways change and every case is different — use this to ask better questions, then confirm each step with an immigration attorney.

THE IMG PATHWAY, STEP BY STEP

- 1 J-1 Visa (via ECFMG)**
The most common route into a U.S. residency for international medical graduates, sponsored through [ECFMG](#).
- 2 J-1 Waiver Options**
Conrad 30 — via the Texas DSHS Primary Care Office — is the most common waiver for physicians who'll serve in an underserved area.
- 3 H-1B (Employer-Sponsored)**
A dual-intent visa, meaning it allows you to pursue permanent residency in parallel — often the next step after training.
- 4 TMB Licensure**
The [Texas Medical Board](#) licenses via its Substantial Equivalence list or FCVS credential verification.
- 5 TMB Provisional License**
A pathway for foreign-licensed physicians who already hold a Texas offer — a faster on-ramp to practice.

FOR NURSES — THE 60-DAY RULE

Texas is a full [Nurse Licensure Compact](#) state, so a nurse with an active multistate license can practice *immediately*. But permanently relocating means you must apply for endorsement within **60 days** — **there is no grace period**. Fingerprinting (the FAST system) and the Jurisprudence Exam are the usual delay points, so start both the moment you accept. Note: APRNs need separate individual state licenses; the NLC doesn't cover APRN practice.

BOARD & LICENSURE EXAM PREP

USMLE & BOARD EXAM TUTORING

IN-PERSON, HOUSTON

GoldUSMLE Review & USMLE Success Academy

Live, in-person Houston courses for hands-on learners.

BOUTIQUE

MedSchoolCoach & MedBoardTutors

Physician-founded, highly selective national boutiques.

BUDGET

Wyzant & Varsity Tutors

Many tutors are current Baylor / UTHealth residents.

NCLEX PREP

Kaplan

Established national NCLEX prep with structured courses.

Archer Review

Also covers TEAS 7 for those entering nursing school.

Wyzant Local RN Tutors

Some hold CCRN / PCCN for specialty-cert help too.

CME THAT COVERS THE WHOLE HOUSEHOLD

Houston Methodist's ISAC conference — and events like it — award physician, nursing, respiratory therapy, PA, and pharmacist credit at the **same event**. A physician and their NP or PT spouse can genuinely attend together and both earn credit.



SECTION FIVE

PRIVATE TUTORING FOR A MID-YEAR SCHOOL TRANSITION

A match or a start date rarely lines up with the school calendar. When children arrive mid-year, the right tutor isn't about prestige — it's about the specific problem you're solving. Start there:

ONE FIRM FOR THE KIDS — AND A SPOUSE ON BOARDS

Advantage Testing

Thirty years established, and it also tutors the MCAT, NCLEX, and Bar Exam — so one firm can serve both your children and a spouse finishing their own boards.

YOU WANT GENUINELY EXCLUSIVE

Elite Private Tutors

Interviews every family before accepting them — the closest match to a truly selective, high-touch relationship.

PRIVATE-SCHOOL ADMISSIONS & ISEE

General Academic

Based in Rice Village, specializing in private-school admissions and ISEE preparation — ideal if a new school placement is the priority.

A TRANSCRIPT GAP TO CLOSE

Elite Prep Houston

Offers actual accredited, for-credit coursework — the option when a mid-year move leaves a hole in the transcript that needs to be filled properly.

ON A RESIDENT'S BUDGET

The premium firms above earn their fee when the stakes are highest — but you don't always need them. For board & licensure prep, **Wyzant** and **Varsity Tutors** field current Baylor and UTHealth residents at a fraction of the cost, and **Archer Review** covers NCLEX and TEAS 7 affordably. That same peer-tutor route works for the kids' core subjects, too.

SCHOOLS, MATCHED TO YOUR FAMILY

Zoning, private-school fit, and commute all interact. Ask about the Schools pillar when we talk — it's often the deciding factor in where a medical family lands.

SECTION SIX

YOUR GO-TO RESOURCES FOR MEDICAL FAMILIES

Medicine can be isolating for the whole household — especially right after a move. These are the communities and organizations worth finding early.

NATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS & COMMUNITIES

AMA Alliance

TMA Alliance

Texas Medical Association

The Other Side of Medicine

The Med Commons

Dads Married to Doctors+

Fills a real gap

Lives of Doctor Wives

Married to Doctors

Podcast

Side by Side

National + local chapter

LOCAL — HOUSTON

Houston Physician Wives / Partners

Facebook group

Read Between Rounds

Book club

Side by Side Houston

Houston MedSpouses

Instagram

Harris County Medical Society + HCMS Alliance

Est. 1919 — a real institutional anchor

HCMS Physician Wellness

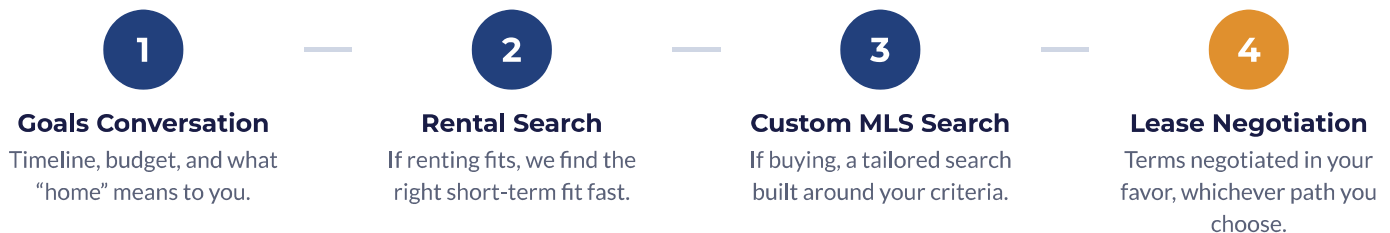
Support line



THE RENT VS. BUY FRAMEWORK

For a physician, rent-vs-buy is rarely about the house itself — it's about the shape of the next few years. A short residency, a fellowship match that could send you anywhere, a spouse's career still in motion: any one of them can make renting the smart, flexible choice, while a long attending contract and a settled household can make buying the wealth-building one. There's no universal right answer — only the right answer for your timeline. Here's the process I walk every client through, and the questions that tip the decision.

MY FOUR-STEP PROCESS



FACTORS TO WEIGH

It usually comes down to four honest questions — the math tends to follow the answers:

- **Training Length**
 A three-year residency or a seven-year surgical track? The longer you'll be in Houston, the more time a home has to overcome closing costs and build real equity.
- **Home vs. Roots**
 Some just need a place to sleep between shifts; others want a door that's truly their own. Be honest about which one you are — it weighs as much as the numbers.
- **Investment Appetite**
 Buying turns rent into equity and a stake in Houston's market. If that upside energizes you — and you can ride out a dip — it leans toward owning.
- **Maintenance Readiness**
 Every home has a to-do list: the water heater, the yard, the repair that lands on a call weekend. Renting hands that list to someone else — worth real money when time is scarce.

RENTING OFTEN WINS WHEN...

It's a short training stop, your match could still move you, a partner's job is in flux — or you simply want flexibility and zero maintenance while life is at its busiest.

BUYING OFTEN WINS WHEN...

You'll be in Houston five-plus years, your income is steady, you want to build equity instead of paying someone else's, and you're ready for the upkeep a home asks.

RUN THE NUMBERS YOURSELF

Two calculators I trust for a first gut-check: the [New York Times](#) Rent vs. Buy calculator and the [NerdWallet](#) Rent vs. Buy calculator. Bring your results and we'll pressure-test them together. But remember what a calculator can't price — a 2 a.m. commute, a school you love, a fellowship that might move you in a year. That's the part we work through side by side.

PHYSICIAN MORTGAGE LENDERS

Physician loan programs are built for exactly your situation: strong future income, but student debt and a job that hasn't started yet. Used well, they change what's possible on day one.

LOW / NO DOWN PAYMENT

Preserve cash for the move itself.

NO PMI

Skip private mortgage insurance entirely.

APPROVED OFF A CONTRACT

Qualify on a signed offer — before you start.

LENDERS WITH PHYSICIAN PROGRAMS

LendFriend Mortgage

Alliant Credit Union

KeyBank

Huntington Bank

Extraco

NEO Home Loans

Hancock Whitney

How to use this list: These are starting points for your own research, not tiered recommendations. Programs, rates, and terms change constantly — compare a few and confirm current offerings directly before you commit. Happy to talk through what I'm seeing clients use right now.





NEXT STEPS

You're not just moving — you're starting a residency, a fellowship, an attending position, or a new chapter with a whole household to match. The housing decision sits at the center of all of it, and it doesn't have to be the stressful part.

Let's talk about what *your* specific timeline needs — from a first rental near TMC to a long-term home for the years after training. Reach out to Fay directly.

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